



Pole Marking

Ref no:	Module 5	Calders & Grandidge	
Compiled By: D. Losty	Pole Marking	Revision 11	
Effective Date: Mar 2020		Revision Date: Dec 2024	

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1 Marking

1.1 General

Each pole shall contain approved ^{UK}CA marking details (except those poles that are not manufactured to the standard EN 14229). Ordinarily, the details are incorporated within the characters on the Pole Identification Tag. However, in extenuating circumstances (and subject to supervisory approval) the details may be contained in a metal disc firmly affixed at 3.5 metres from the pole butt, on the same side as the gouging.

Each pole shall have a gouge or brand mark at least 100mm long, 5mm wide and 3mm deep placed 3.0m from the butt and shall be marked with the information specified in 1.2 & 1.3 in characters not less than 25mm high (for BT not less than 50mm high x 25mm wide) and gouged or branded 5mm wide and 3mm in depth. Spacing's between codes shall be between 20mm and 30mm.

1.2 Above the Gouge Mark

Each pole shall be marked with the following information above the gouge mark:

- Length of pole (in m)
- Class of pole, i.e. L (light), M (Medium), or S (Stout) and/or, the nominal diameter (in mm) at 1.5 m from the butt

Notes:

- The ownership mark may also be marked if required.
- The nominal tip diameter (in mm) may also be marked if required.
- Refer to sketches below for individual customer requirements.

1.3 Below the gouge mark

Each pole shall be marked with the following information below the gouge mark:

Marking Code	Species	Country of Origin		Last two digits of year of preservation
PL or (CF)	Corsican Pine	GB	United Kingdom	
PM or (DF)	Douglas Fir	CA	Canada	
LP	Lodgepole Pine	FI	Finland	
LX	Larch, Dunkeld /	NO	Norway	
LX	Larch, European /	SE	Sweden	
LX	Larch, Japanese			

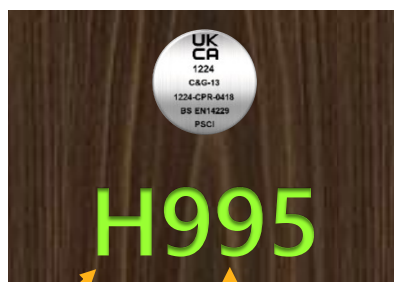
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NS	Norway Spruce			
PS or (SP)	Scots Pine or Redwood	FI	Finland	
		PO	Poland	
SS	Sitka Spruce			
WC	Western Red Cedar			
SYP	Southern Yellow Pine	US	United States	

Note: The depot supplying the pole and the name or mark of the preserver may also be marked.

All 'H' poles shall be supplied as matched pairs. These poles shall be marked so that they are easily identifiable from similar poles in the delivery.

In the example shown below, the text on the pole indicates that the pole is one leg of a pair of poles. The unique numbering of pairs of poles is contained on the pre-printed butt tags and the numbers gouged into the pole surface must match those on the tags.

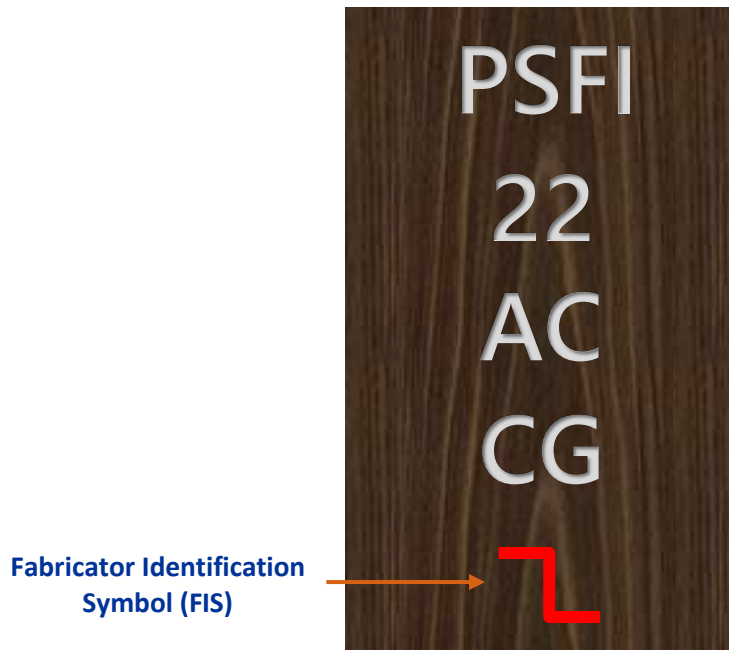


'H' Denoting 'H' Pole

Sequential No.

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Other than the Fabricator Identification Symbol (which is placed beneath all of the pole information), poles preserved with creosote shall carry no other distinguishing mark. Other forms of preservation shall be denoted by appropriate letters (refer to Appendix C).



When raw poles have been fabricated, the fabricator must apply a single black line across the gouging, using black spray paint. For Tanalith treated poles, the fabricator must apply a single green line across the gouging, and over the CE disc locating hole, using green spray paint.

1.4 The Butt End

The preferred marking method on the butts of poles is the use of pre-printed Pole Identification Tags. In the absence of such tag (for example during an unplanned outage of the Laser Marking Machine) the following methodology may be used.

Each pole shall have the following information impressed on the butt end grain:

- Length of pole (in m)
- Class of pole, i.e. L (light), M (Medium), or S (Stout) or alternatively, the diameter (in mm) at 1.5 m from the butt
- The inspector's hammer stamp.

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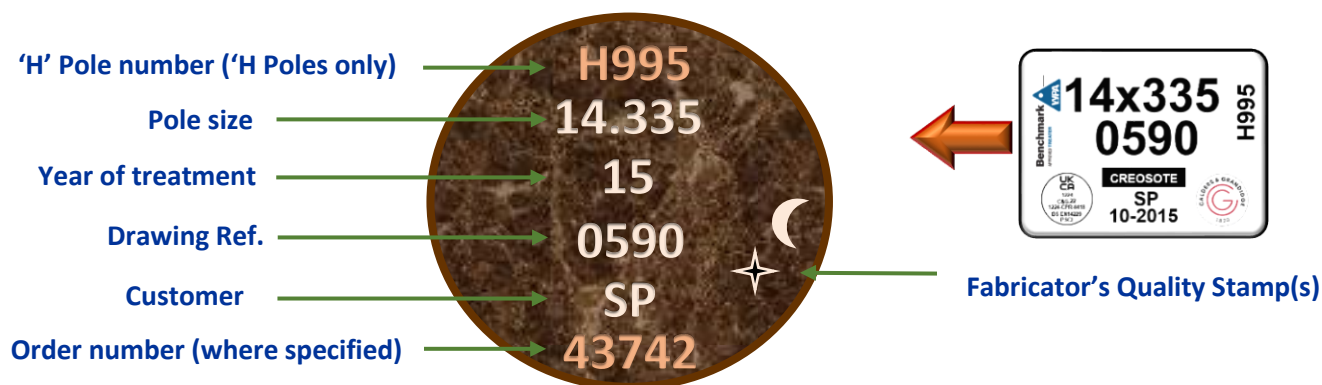
Additionally, **non**-BT poles shall have the following information impressed on the butt end grain:

- The year of treatment.
- The drawing number that the pole has been fabricated to.
- The customer (i.e. SP, ENW, UKPN, CE)

Further information may also be required (depending on the drawing and customer), as follows:

- The pair number for pairs of 'H' poles (H1, H2, H3 etc.)
- An order number, where this has been requested.
- Alphabetical lettering, where this has been requested.
- Abbreviations denoting the placement of the pole within a line – for example SECT to denote a Section Pole, INT to denote an Intermediate Pole and so on.

The example below shows typical butt impressions:

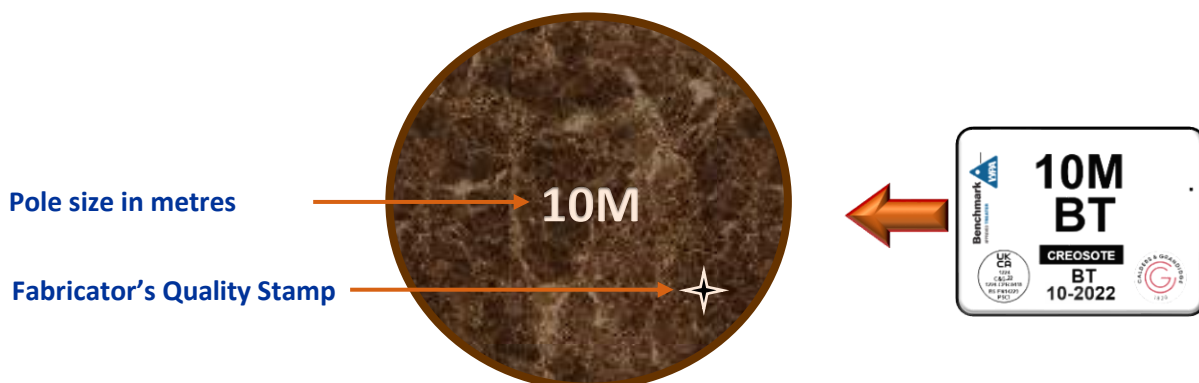
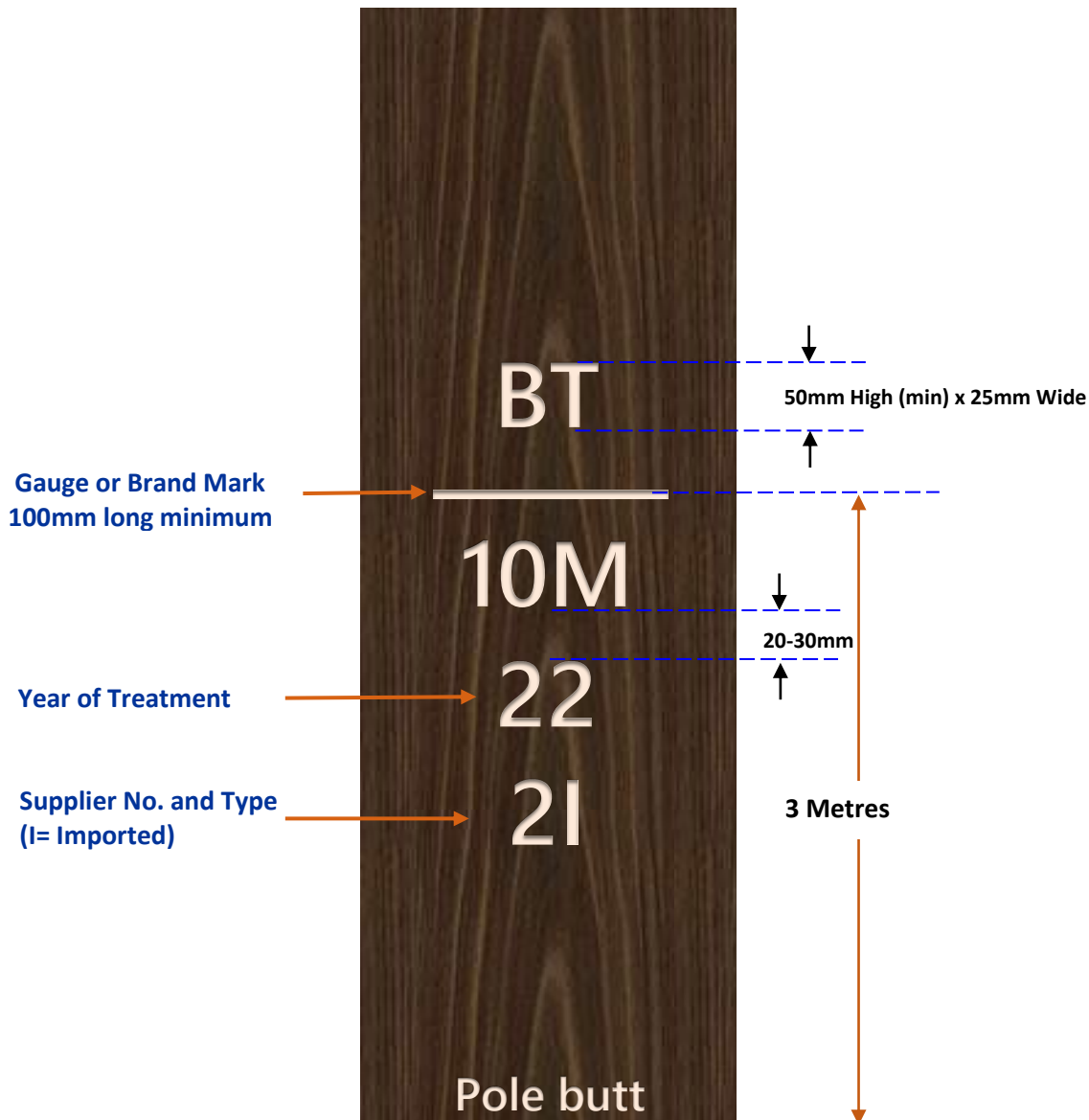


1.5 The Tip End

On completion of fabrication, the fabricator who worked on the tip end of the pole must hammer stamp the pole tip with the personally issued quality hammer.

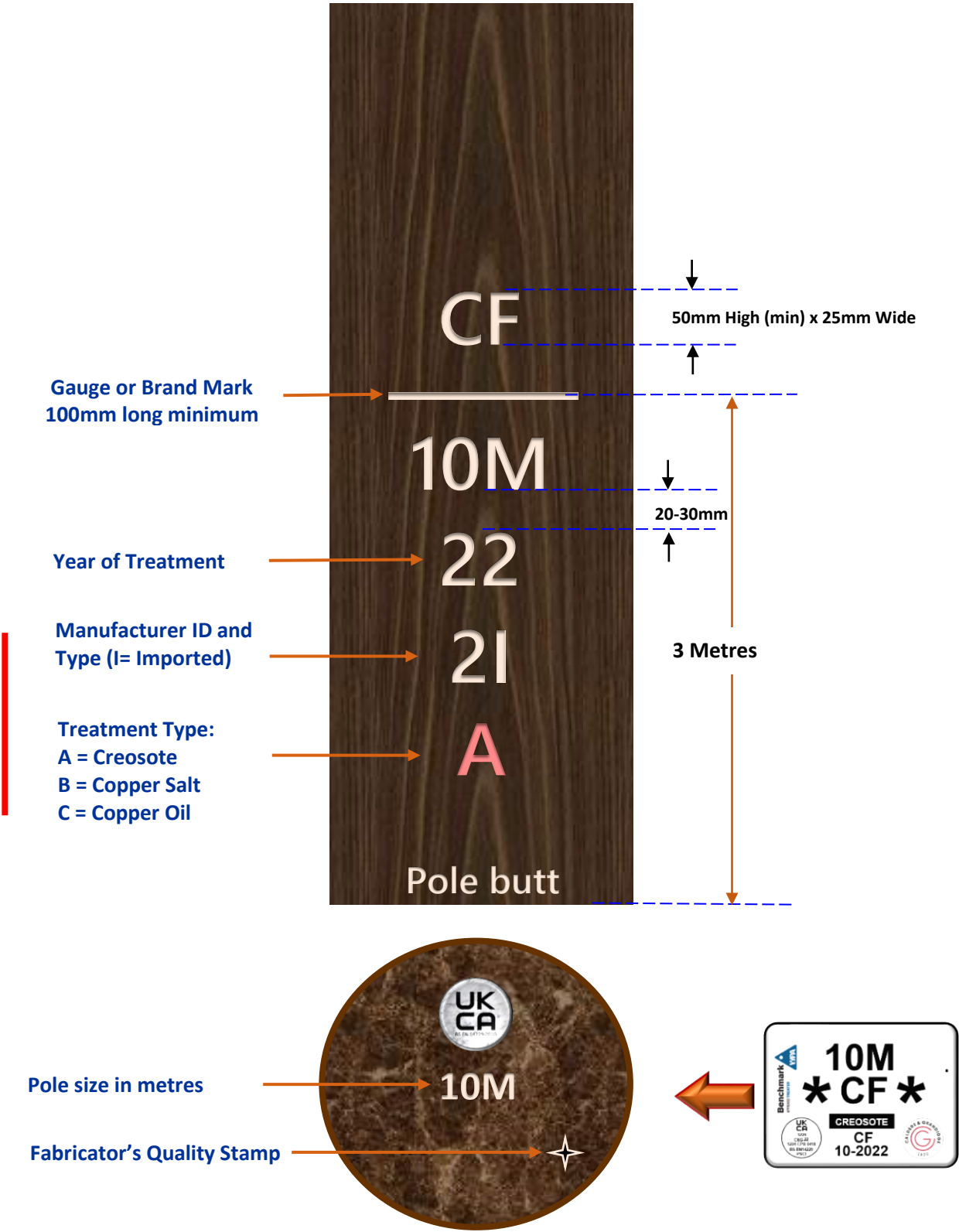
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2.1 BT Creosote



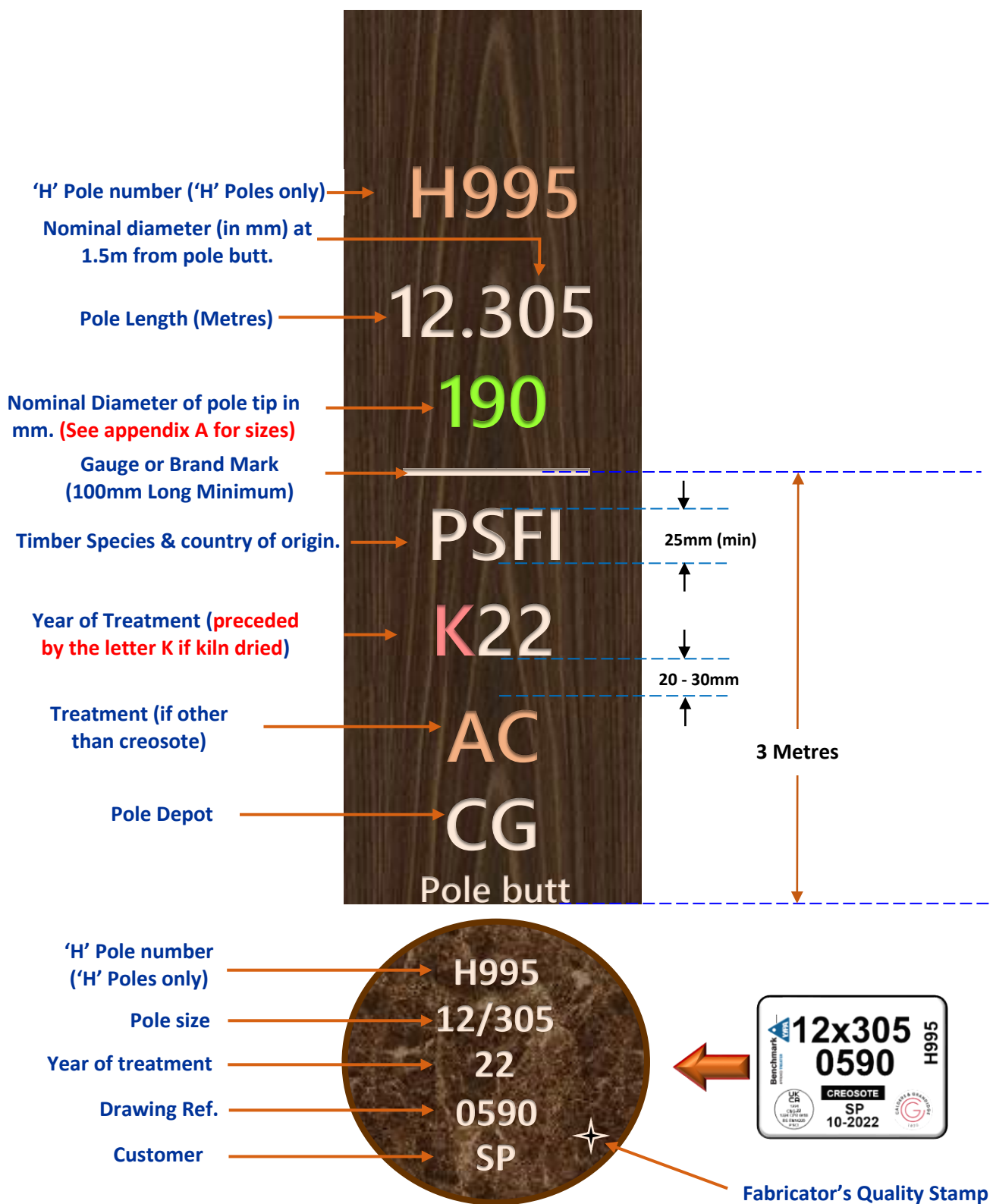
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2.2
CityFibre



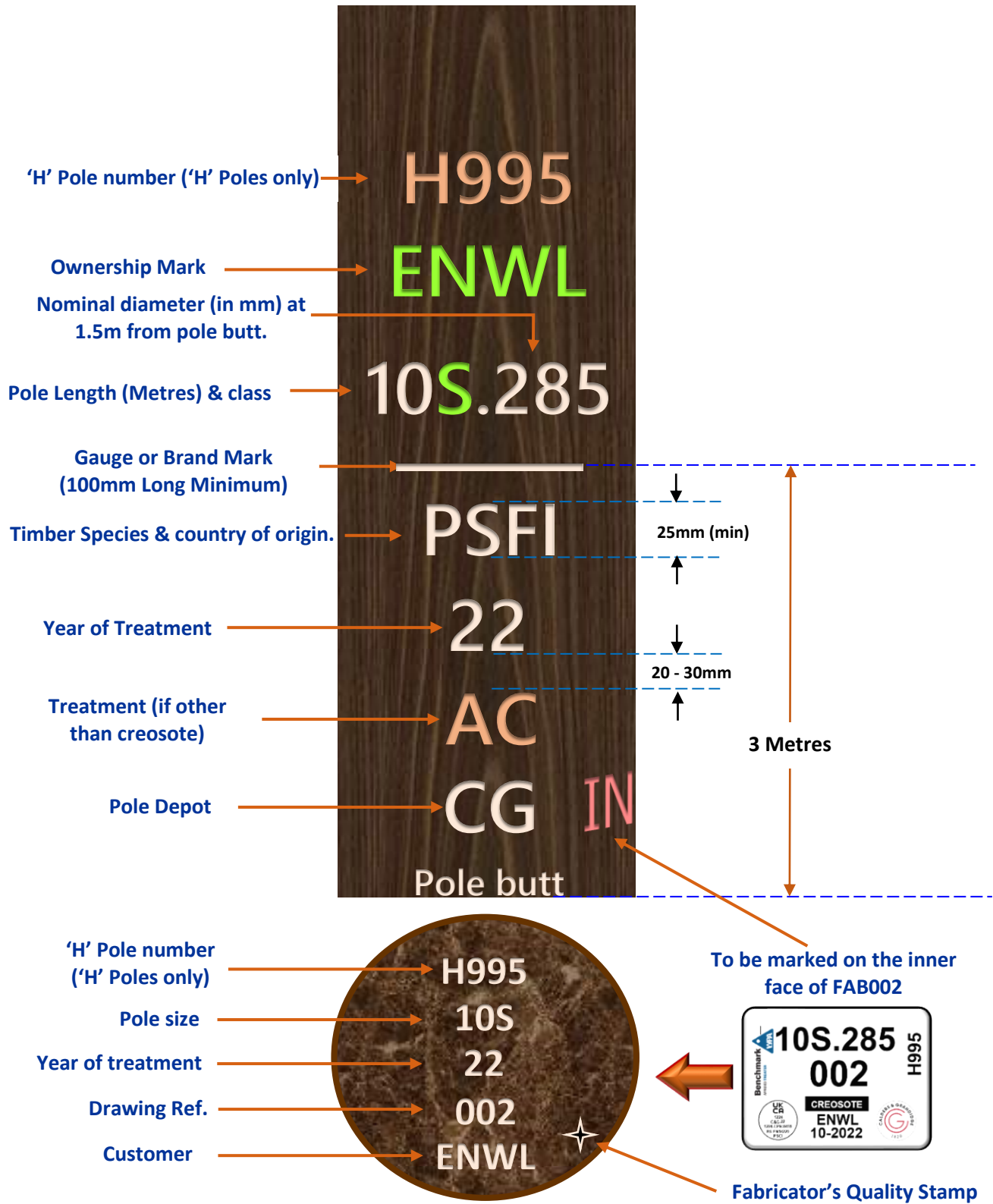
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2.4 Scottish Power



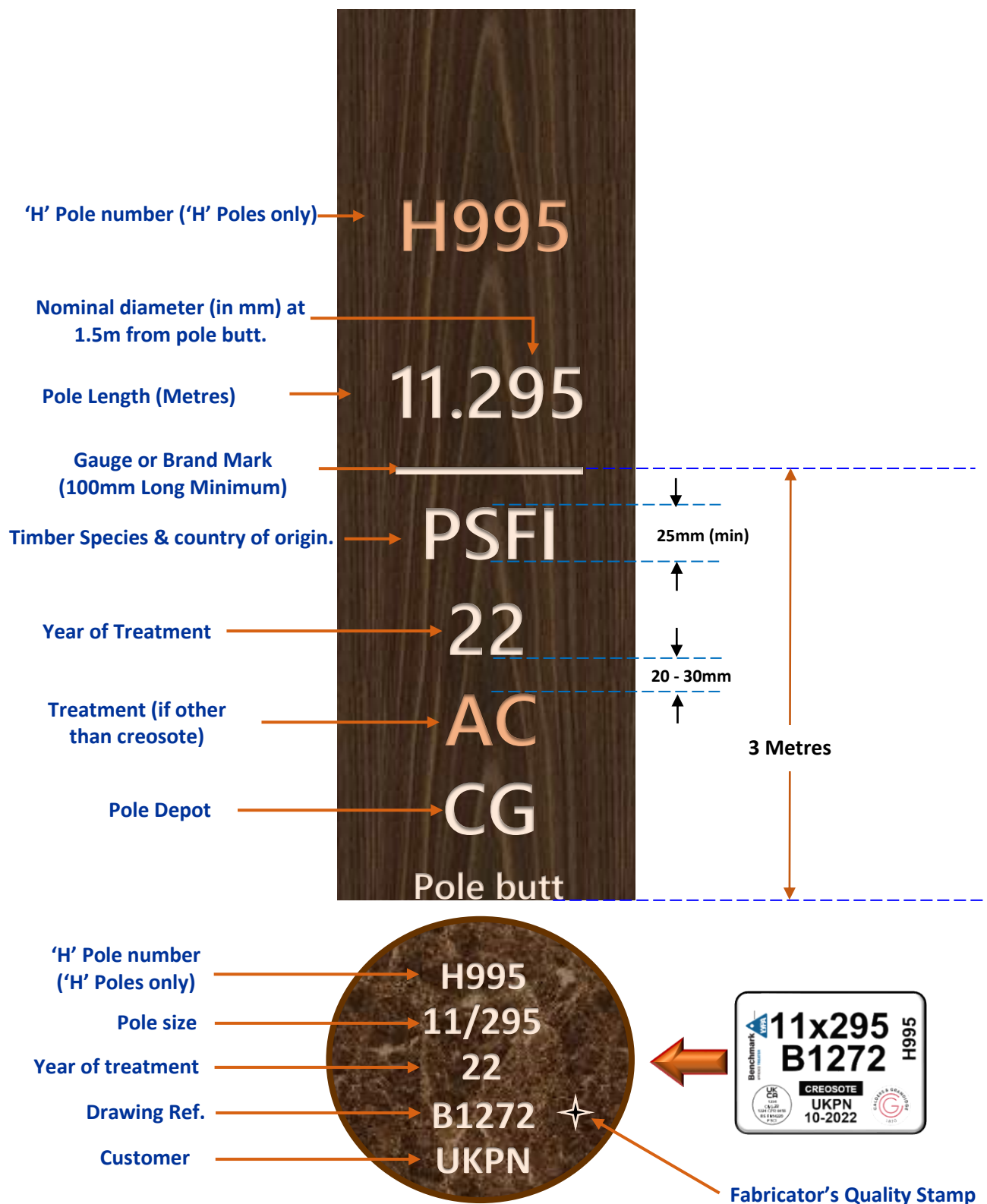
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2.5 ENW



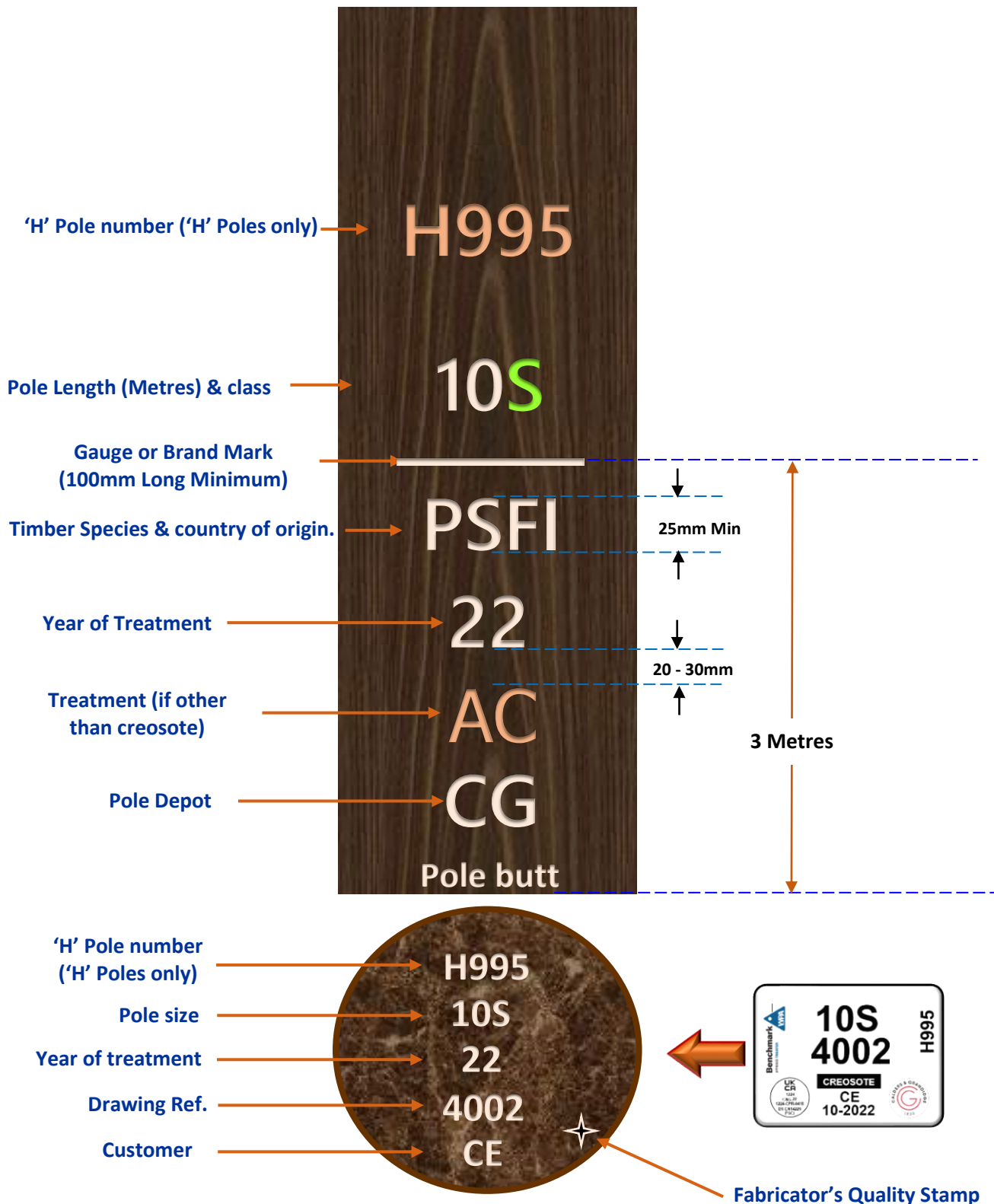
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2.6 UKPN



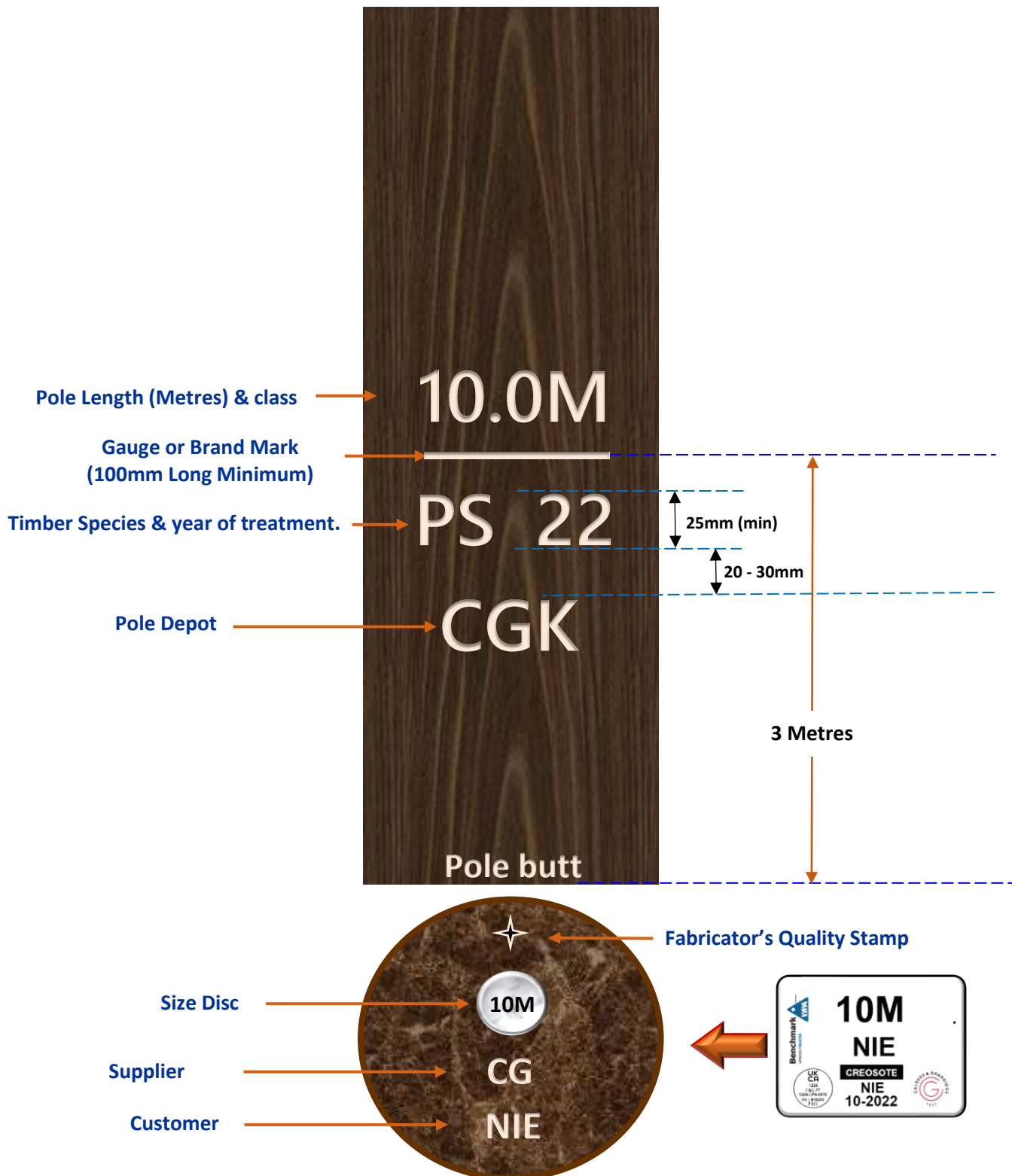
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2.7 NPG



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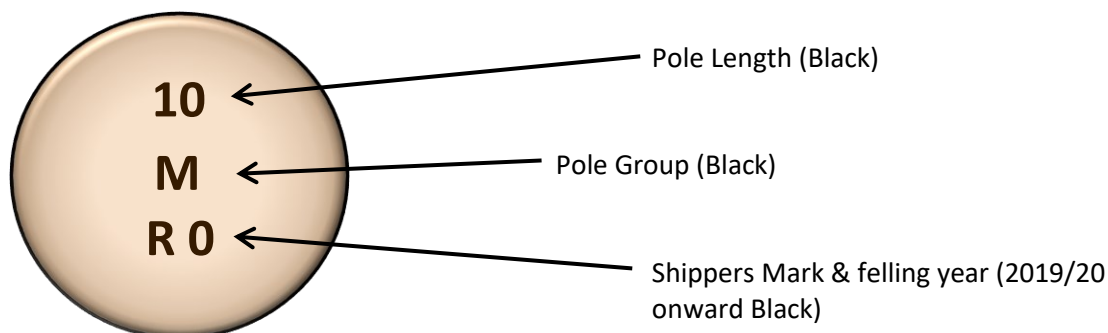
2.9 NIE – Stock Poles Only



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APPENDIX A – Supplier Pole Marking

All pole butts should be marked by suppliers with: -



Shippers Mark

Finprofile	PP
Heinonen	H
Huomo	L
Mononen	O
Polonen	M
Rundvirke	R
Talka	A
Versowood	K
Pinar	PI
Jauda-Koks	J
Paras	P
Norra Skog	N

Shippers Mark – Colour

2013/14	Green
2014/15	Blue
2015/16	Red
2016/17	Black
2017/18	Green
2018/19	Blue

From 2019/20 onward

2019/20	0
2020/21	1
2021/22	2
2022/23	3

Pole Length - In Black, Except Eircom in **GREEN**

6	12
7	13
8	14
8.5	15
9	16
9.5	17
10	18
10.5	20
11	22
11.5	24

Pole Group – In Black

Light	L
Medium	M
Medium-Stout	MS
Stout	S
X Stout	X
XX Stout	XX
Super Stout	SS

ESB poles must have the relevant size code marked in place of the length and group

151	219	220	260	262	263	315
363	133	414	143	468	153	511



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Certification Body
Identifying Mark
Certificate of Conformity
Standard Reference
Declaration of Performance
Reference



Imported – Pinus Sylvestris
Scots Pine – Creosote Treated

Imported – Pinus Sylvestris
Scots Pine – Green Treated



Imported – Pseudotsuga Menziesii
Douglas Fir – Creosote Treated



Imported – Pseudotsuga Menziesii
Douglas Fir – Green Treated

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APPENDIX B - Tip Sizes for Scottish Power Stout/ Extra Stout Poles

Pole Length (in metres)	Pole Diameter @ 1.5m from Butt	Pole Top Diameter (in mm)
8.5	265	190
8.5	285	206
9	275	191
9	295	211
9.5	280	190
9.5	300	210
10	285	190
10	305	209
10	325	229
10.5	290	190
10.5	310	209
10.5	330	229
11	295	190
11	315	208
11	335	228
11.5	300	190
11.5	320	208
11.5	340	228
12	305	190
12	325	207
12	345	227
13	320	195
13	340	211
13	360	231
14	335	195
14	355	214
14	375	234
15	350	195
15	370	218
15	390	238
16	365	200
16	385	222
16	405	242

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APPENDIX C – Designations Used to Indicate Treatments Other than Creosote

The following designations are utilised on wood pole surfaces and have the meanings shown:

Designation	Meaning
AC	Pole is treated with AC500 preservative.
PP	Pole is treated with PoleProtect preservative.
TL	Pole is treated with TANALITH™ E8000 preservative.
TS	Pole is treated with Tanasote™ S40 preservative
No Designation	Pole is treated with Creosote.

Documents Replaced by this Module

Document Ref.	Document Title
QTG55	Pole Marking
QTG54	CE Marking for Structural Timber Wood Poles
QTG27	Recording and Resolving Pole Defects
QTG93	Supplier Pole Marking

Updates

Date	Amendment	By
25.05.18	Month of treatment added to WPD	EL
04.06.18	Month/year of treatment format changed to 05-2015	DL
5.12.19	Supplier pole marking details amended to reflect new practices.	DL
17.2.20	NIE Pole marking arrangements added.	DL
12.3.20	QTG55 changed to Module 5	DL
25-3-20	Amended to incorporate feedback from End User reviews.	DL
20-7-20	Requirements for Fabricator Symbols added.	DL
31-8-20	Instructions for unqualified Fabrication Assistants added (for symbols).	DL
2-3-21	Format updated	DL
25-6-21	Numbering format for 'H' poles changed following customer request.	DL
13-7-21	Nomenclature for alternative treatments added in new Appendix C.	DL
14-12-21	Supplier code change for CityFibre Poles + Tanalith code added to Appendix C.	DL
18-8-2022	All references to WPD changed to NGED to comply with EE SPEC: 129/2.	DL
25-10-2022	Details of laser butt tags included	DL
18-11-2024	New suppliers (Paras and Norra Skogg) added, along with identification letters.	DL
10-12-2024	SSE marking requirements added.	DL